MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 5/15/2024

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

Unapproved minutes
April 17, 2024

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Samantha Pitchford, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 6 Jack Kleinhardt

OTHERS PRESENT

Deputy Clerk & Register of Deeds Polly Raycraft, Administrator Lori Phelps, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the agenda, **motion carried**

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gilmore to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of March 20, 2024 and Committee of the Whole Minutes of April 3, 2024, with corrections, **motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

There were citizens requesting help from the Board of Commissioners regarding, what they believe to be contamination to their property from the land fill facility. Chairman Haskell agreed to check with the Health Department and see what can be done or what has been done to check on this situation.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

a. Flyer Paula Pirnstill Memorial Health & Safety Fair – No discussion
b. Notification from Farwell of Master Plan update – No discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps announced that Rudi Hicks is retiring from the Clare County Animal Control. Chairman Haskell read Resolution 24-3 Special Tribute to Rudi Hicks for serving Clare County for over 12 years.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Pete Preston, Director of Equalization
   Director Preston described the culmination of the equalization process and how the assessment process between the Equalization Department and the local Assessors. Director Preston is asking that the Board of Commissioners approve the L-4024, which is entire set of data for each local unit added up for the County's final equalization that will be sent to the State of Michigan.

   Director Preston reported that Clare County has had a sizable increase in market value which affects the assessed value. Clare County's assessed value has increased by 17%. There was also a high inflation rate, which drives up the taxable value.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS - continued

1. Pete Preston, Director of Equalization – continued
   Director Preston confirmed there is a 10.7% taxable value increase and is the highest increase Mr. Preston has seen of any of the counties his business provides services to. That will result in an increase of $600,000.00 in revenue for Clare County.

   a. Resolution 24-12
      It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to accept the equalized value recommendation presented by the County Equalization Director of $2,111,542,390.00 for Clare County set forth in Resolution 24-12, roll call vote revealed:

      Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Housler, Majewski, Fancon, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Hoefling, Pitchford and Haskell
      Nays: (0)
      Absent: (1) ~~bring~~ being Commissioner Kleinhardt
      Motion for Resolution carried

   b. State Tax Commission Assessment L-4037
      It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the State Tax Commission Assessment Roll Certification, County Board of Commissioner, CBC, L-4037 and allow Chair to sign, roll call vote revealed:

      Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Hoefling, Housler, Fancon, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Pitchford and Haskell
      Nays: (0)
      Absent: (1) ~~bring~~ being Commissioner Kleinhardt
      Motion carried

   c. Personal Real Property Totals L-4024
      It was moved by Commissioner Pitchford, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the Personal and Real Property totals, L-4024 and allow the Chair to sign, roll call vote revealed:

      Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Pitchford, Hoefling, Fancon, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Housler and Haskell
      Nays: (0)
      Absent: (1) ~~bring~~ being Commissioner Kleinhardt
      Motion carried

   d. Contract for Services through Clare County Equalization and Townships
      It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gilmore to approve the contract for services through Clare County Equalization and the townships and allow the Chair to sign, **motion carried**

JUSTICE

1. Emergency Services
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the Homeland Security Grant Program Intergovernmental Agreement between West Michigan Reginal Medical Consortium and Clare County and allow the Chair to sign, **motion carried**

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Gilmore, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of March 18, 2024 in the amount of $74,721.68 general fund claims and the March 19th general fund claims of $1,061.89 and minutes of April 1, 2024 in the amount of $57,372.19, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Gilmore, Housler, Pitchford, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion carried

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the expenditures for the month of March, 2024, in the amount of $4,672,293.80 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,336,938.12, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Fancon, Housler, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Gilmore, Hoefling, Pitchford and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion carried

3. Resolution for Animal Control Millage
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to adopt Resolution 24-08 for the purpose of submitting a proposal to the qualified voters of Clare County for the animal Control Millage Renewal Proposal, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Housler, Hoefling, Fancon, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Pitchford and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) ~~bring~~ being Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion for Resolution carried

4. Resolution for E911/Central Dispatch Millage
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to adopt Resolution 24-09 for the purpose of submitting a proposal to the qualified voters of Clare County for the E911/Central Dispatch Millage Renewal Proposal, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Hoefling, Majewski, Pitchford, Fancon, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Housler and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) ~~bring~~ being Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion for Resolution carried

5. Resolution for Senior Citizens Millage Renewal
   It was moved by Commissioner Pitchford, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to adopt Resolution 24-10 for the purpose of submitting a proposal to the qualified voters of Clare County for the Senior Citizens Services Millage Renewal Proposal, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Pitchford, Hoefling, Fancon, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Housler and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) bring Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion for Resolution carried

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

6. Resolution for Spongy Moth Millage Renewal
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to adopt Resolution 24-11 for the purpose of submitting a proposal to the qualified voters of Clare County for the Spongy Moth Suppression Millage Renewal Proposal, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Majewski, Housler, Fancon, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Pitchford, Hoefling and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) bring Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion for Resolution carried

7. Resolution #24-14 Sale of Senior Service Clare Building
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to pass Resolution 24-14 for the sale of 210 Wilcox Parkway owned by Clare County Senior Services as set forth in the 24-14 Resolution, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Hoefling, Fancon, Gilmore, Pitchford, Majewski, Housler and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) bring Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion for Resolution carried

8. Election Software Purchase
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the purchase of election reporting software in the amount of $5,000.00 and yearly licensing fee of $1,500.00 for a total this year of $6,500.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (4) being Commissioners Majewski, Pitchford, Hoefling and Haskell
   Nays: (4) being Commissioners Fancon, Housler, Ambrozaitis and Gilmore
   Absent: (1) ~~bring~~ being Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion failed

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

No report

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners. Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger has settled with all the local units for the 2023 tax year. Her office has also sent out just under 6,000 notices. It looks like this year's auction of property will be the lowest she has ever seen at under 30 properties.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman Jeff Haskell reported that on April 3, 2024 the CTE program had a job fair with 30-40 local businesses available to meet with the students. He also reported that Clare County's unemployment rate is still at 6.7%.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Dale Majewski has been attending his meetings – no report.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Housler has attended her meetings – no report.

Commissioner Hoefling reported on each of the township's he serves, Mid Michigan Community Action Agency's new food program, Farwell LDFA meeting, Michigan State University Extension, Local Emergency Planning Commission and the 911 Board.

Commissioner Pitchford reported on the township she serves.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis reported on the Cranberry Lake Improvement Board, the Airport Committee Meeting.

Commissioner Gilmore has been attending his meetings – no report.

Commissioner Fancon had no report

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

Administrator Phelps will report on the County's Budget at the Committee of the Whole meeting scheduled in two weeks.

PUBLIC COMMENT

None

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

Meeting Adjourned at 9:33 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

Jeff Haskell, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners